too was reluctant to advance further, so through the morning they continued to fire heavy and medium mortars. Unable to crack Arni I and Arni II, the Chinese turned their full attention on Dabu post that was defended by ten men. The quantum of fire brought to bear on Dabu forced the defenders to pull out under the cover of darkness. However, there were no casualties at Dabu post.

With Dabu in Chinese hands, on the morning of 22 October, Arni I and Arni II were now isolated. There had been no let up in the bombardment and every now and then Chinese jitter parties would open fire with MMGs. Ammunition was soon running low and Chand Singh sent out an SOS to Second Lieutenant Harish Chandra Gujral, commanding Arni II. Not wanting to expose his men, Gujral handed over charge of Arni II to Havildar Dharam Singh and personally made five runs in a Willy's jeep between Arni I and Arni II. Despite the Chinese targeting him, incredibly, they failed to bring him down. On the return journey, each time he ferried the wounded to Arni II. This display of bravery only raised the morale of the stubborn Jats further. Finally, under cover of darkness, the Jats broke contact with the Chinese and fell back on DBO.

Another post occupied by the men of Charlie Company of 5 Jat was Filter II. This post was also subjected to continuous mortar fire, but in this case the Chinese made no attempt to assault it. This post was also abandoned on the night of 22 October. By 25 October, the last straggler had fallen back on DBO.

THE SAGA OF 14 J&K MILITIA

Reports coming in from various posts clearly indicated to Major S. S. Randhawa, the 2IC of 14 J&K Militia and the overall sector commander for DBO, that the Chinese were trying to dislodge the Indian troops from their posts. Around the time Brigadier Das landed at DBO, Randhawa was moving from Murgo towards Tr Jn with the intention of reinforcing the defences there. Once it was confirmed that Bijoy and Trikoni Posts had fallen, the line of communication to Sultan Chushku became vulnerable. Orders were then passed to all posts in the Sultan Chushku area to withdraw either to Tr Jn, DBO or Burtse.

On 22 October, the BBC flashed the news that DBO had fallen to Chinese forces. Randhawa immediately sent a message to the XV Corps Tac HQ saying that if DBO had indeed fallen, Tr Jn must be held at all